

## Handout 4.5: Greener Room Swap

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Partner: \_\_\_\_\_

**Directions:** Fill in Part 1 and Part 2 with the class. Part 3 is the swap. Read about the room. For every item, write a greener swap. Write the green factor it makes better. Write whether the swap is free, cheap (under \$25), or money. Then pick your top three.

### Word bank in Spanish

| English       | Spanish                 |
|---------------|-------------------------|
| reduce        | reducir                 |
| reuse         | reutilizar              |
| recycle       | reciclar                |
| compost       | compost (abono)         |
| secondhand    | de segunda mano (usado) |
| natural light | luz natural             |
| waste         | desecho (basura)        |

### Part 1: The four Rs and the five green factors

| The four Rs                    | What it means at home | One example          |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| Reduce                         |                       |                      |
| Reuse                          |                       |                      |
| Recycle                        |                       |                      |
| Compost ("rot")                |                       |                      |
| Green factor in a living space |                       | What makes it better |
| Natural light                  |                       |                      |
| Materials                      |                       |                      |
| Indoor air                     |                       |                      |
| Water                          |                       |                      |
| Waste                          |                       |                      |

### Part 2: Sort the twelve

Write each item in one bin. Some could go in two; pick the one that does the least harm.

The twelve items:

1. a glass jar
2. a cardboard box
3. a banana peel
4. a plastic bag
5. a T-shirt with a hole
6. a phone charger that works
7. a chipped mug
8. a stack of junk mail
9. a pizza box with grease
10. a wooden chair with a loose leg
11. a plastic water bottle
12. coffee grounds

| REDUCE (do not bring it in) | REUSE | RECYCLE | COMPOST |
|-----------------------------|-------|---------|---------|
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |
|                             |       |         |         |

### Part 3: The room

**A teen's bedroom.** The window has a broken blind that is stuck closed, so the lamp is on all day. The desk is particleboard and wobbles; the plan is to throw it out and buy another one like it for \$60. A can of aerosol air freshener sits on the dresser and gets sprayed every morning. Clothes and school things are stored in a set of six new plastic tubs bought last month. The bookshelf is a fast-furniture shelf that sagged in a year. A trash bag by the door holds clothes that do not fit anymore, headed for the curb. The radiator valve drips into a bucket that gets emptied every day. A fan runs all day, every day, with the door closed and the window shut.

| # | The item                                 | Greener swap | Green factor<br>(light /<br>materials / air /<br>water / waste) | Free / cheap<br>(under \$25) /<br>money |
|---|------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 1 | Broken blind,<br>lamp on all day         |              |                                                                 |                                         |
| 2 | Wobbly<br>particleboard<br>desk, replace |              |                                                                 |                                         |

|   |                                       |  |  |  |
|---|---------------------------------------|--|--|--|
|   | with the same                         |  |  |  |
| 3 | Aerosol air freshener every morning   |  |  |  |
| 4 | Six new plastic tubs                  |  |  |  |
| 5 | Sagging fast-furniture bookshelf      |  |  |  |
| 6 | A bag of clothes for the curb         |  |  |  |
| 7 | Radiator valve dripping into a bucket |  |  |  |
| 8 | Fan all day, door and window shut     |  |  |  |

**Top three** (most good for the least money), one sentence each on why:

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_
3. \_\_\_\_\_

**Grade 8 stretch:** Write two sentences to the landlord asking for the radiator valve to be fixed. Talk about the wasted water and the money, not feelings.

Sentence 1: \_\_\_\_\_

Sentence 2: \_\_\_\_\_